

WISDOM OF THE EAST

THE PERSIAN MYSTICS

JALĀLU'D-DIN RUMĪ

By F. HADLAND DAVIS

AUTHOR OF "IN THE VALLEY OF STARS
THERE IS A TOWER OF SILENCE"



LONDON

JOHN MURRAY, ALBEMARLE STREET

1912

ALL RIGHTS RESERVED

TO

A. T. K.

THIS LITTLE BOOK OF EASTERN WISDOM

IS LOVINGLY INSCRIBED

"OUR JOURNEY IS TO THE ROSE-GARDEN OF UNION"
JALÁLU'D-DÍN RÚMÍ.

PREFACE

I DESIRE to thank Mr. R. A. Nicholson for his kind and generous permission to use selections from his *Dīvāni Shamsi Tabrīz*, and also his publishers, the Cambridge Press. I am deeply indebted to Mr. E. H. Whinfield for allowing me to use quotations from his rendering of the *Masnavi* (Trübner's Oriental Series). I also cordially thank Mr. John Hastie for giving me permission to quote a few passages from the late Rev. Professor Hastie's "Festival of Spring" (James Maclehose and Sons, Glasgow). The poems quoted from this volume are entitled: "Thy Rose," "I saw the Winter weaving," "Love sounds the Music of the Spheres," "The Souls Love-moved," and "The Beloved All in All." All the other translations from the lyrical poetry of Jalálu'd-Dín Rúmí are by Mr. R. A. Nicholson. To these gentlemen, and to those

I have left unnamed, I tender my warmest thanks for their help, sympathy, and interest in my attempt to “popularise the wisest of the Persian Súfis.”

F. HADLAND DAVIS.

LONDON,

January 22, 1907.

CONTENTS

	PAGE
INTRODUCTION	11
I. ORIGIN OF SÚFÍISM.	11
II. THE EARLY SÚFÍS	14
III. THE NATURE OF SÚFÍISM	20
IV. THE INFLUENCE OF SÚFÍISM	27
V. ANALYSIS OF THE RELIGION OF LOVE	31
THE LIFE AND WORK OF JALÁLU'D-DÍN RÚMÍ	34
I. LIFE	34
II. SHAMSI TABRÍZ	36
III. THE STORIES OF AL-AFLĀKĪ AND THE DEATH OF JALÁLU'D-DÍN RÚMÍ.	38
IV. THE NATURE AND SIGNIFICANCE OF JALÁLU'D- DÍN RÚMÍ'S POETRY	40
SELECTIONS FROM THE "DĪVĀNĪ SHAMSI TABRÍZ"	44
SELECTIONS FROM THE "MASNAVĪ"	68
APPENDIX : A NOTE ON PERSIAN POETRY	101

EDITORIAL NOTE

THE object of the Editors of this series is a very definite one. They desire above all things that, in their humble way, these books shall be the ambassadors of good-will and understanding between East and West—the old world of Thought and the new of Action. In this endeavour, and in their own sphere, they are but followers of the highest example in the land. They are confident that a deeper knowledge of the great ideals and lofty philosophy of Oriental thought may help to a revival of that true spirit of Charity which neither despises nor fears the nation of another creed and colour.

L. CRANMER-BYNG.
S. A. KAPADIA.

NORTHBROOK SOCIETY,
21, CROMWELL ROAD,
KENSINGTON, S.W.

INTRODUCTION

I. THE ORIGIN OF SÚFÍISM

AMONG the Mohammedans SÚfíism, or Persian mysticism, is known as *tasawwuf*. The word SÚfí is derived from *súf*, meaning "wool." When a little Persian sect at the end of the eighth century A.D. broke away from the orthodox Muslim religion, and struck out on an independent path, they ignored costly robes and worldly ostentation, and clad themselves in a white wool garment. Hence they were known as "wool wearers," or SÚfís.

Prof. Edward G. Browne * gives four theories in regard to the origin of SÚfíism, viz. : (1) *Eso-
teric Doctrine of the Prophet*. (2) *Reaction of
the Aryan mind against a Semitic religion*. (3) *Neo-Platonist influence*. (4) *Independent origin*. Neither of the four theories altogether satisfies the learned professor, and very certain it is

* *A Literary History of Persia*, vol. i.

that the last-mentioned theory is of very little account. Prof. Browne seems in favour of a "spontaneous growth" existing in various forms, under various names throughout the civilised world; but after all this is not very tangible evidence. Moreover, we must bear in mind that the Neo-Platonist philosophers paid a visit to the Persian court in the sixth century A.D., and founded a school there in the reign of Núshírwán. It is highly probable, therefore, that these seven philosophers, forced to leave their homes through the tyranny of Justinian, who forbade the teaching of philosophy at Athens, should have had considerable influence upon a few of the more thoughtful Persians. We shall now find that this theory is borne out by internal evidence.

Let us briefly study the tenets of Neo-Platonism. The Neo-Platonists believed in the Supreme Good as the Source of all things. Self-existent, it generated from itself. Creation was the reflection of its own Being. Nature, therefore, was permeated with God. Matter was essentially non-existent, a temporary and ever-moving shadow for the embodiment of the Divine. The Neo-Platonists believed that by ecstasy and contemplation of the All-Good, man would rise to that Source from whence he came. These points bear directly upon the Súfí teaching. They form a broad outline of the tenets of

Súfiism. The Súfís, from temperamental and other causes, elaborated these ideas, gave them a rich and beautiful setting, and, what is all-important, built about them one of the most interesting phases of mystical poetry the world has ever known, and this particular phase may be said to date from the twelfth century A.D.

Thus, I think, it will be readily admitted that the Súfís certainly owed something to the Neo-Platonists. The cry for the Beloved was in their hearts before the Greek philosophers came; but Neo-Platonism appealed to their Oriental minds. It was a stepping-stone across the river of their particular spiritual tendencies, and they trod thereon, and proceeded to lay down other stones across the stream. I have pointed out the similarities between this particular Greek and Persian belief. There was, however, one very important difference. The Neo-Platonist's conception of God was purely abstract, the Súfí's essentially personal, as far as the early Súfís were concerned. We shall consider other influences which were brought to bear upon Súfiism a little later on. There is a very great difference between the early Súfiism and the elaborate additions that followed as an evolutionary matter of course.

In brief, then, Neo-Platonism was the doctrine of Ecstasy. A quotation from the letter of Plotinus to Flaccus on Ecstasy will still further

show the similarities between this Greek and Persian teaching :

“The wise man recognises the idea of the Good within him. This he develops by withdrawal into the Holy Place of his own soul. He who does not understand how the soul contains the Beautiful within itself, seeks to realise beauty without, by laborious production. His aim should rather be to concentrate and simplify, and so to expand his being ; instead of going out into the Manifold, to forsake it for the One, and so to float upwards towards the Divine Fount of Being whose stream flows within him.”

This is Súfism in prose. The Súfís turned the same conception into *poetry*.

II. THE EARLY SÚFÍS.

ABÚ HASHÍM (ob. 150 A.H.) was the first to bear the name of Súfí, while Dhu'l-Nún-al-Misri (245 A.H.) may be said to have given Súfism its permanent shape. Rābi'a, of Basra, was the first woman to join the sect, and her saintliness and wise sayings have been preserved by Farídu'd-Dín 'Attár. One day a great sickness fell upon Rābi'a, and on being asked the reason for it she replied : “I dwelt upon the joys of Paradise and therefore my Beloved has chastened me.”

Rābī'a did not believe in earthly marriage. Her remark on the subject is given as follows : "The bonds of wedlock have descended upon me. I am not my own, but my Lord's, and must not be unfaithful to Him." 'Attār also informs us that when Rābī'a was asked if she hated the devil, she replied : "My love to God leaves me no time to hate him." Rābī'a was a woman of much independence of thought, ethical rather than metaphysical in her remarks, and strongly opposed to outward ceremonials. She is said to have died at Jerusalem, 753 A.D. It was at Ramla, in Palestine, that a Christian nobleman built a convent (*Khāngāh*) for the Sūfīs. Thus in the early days the sect defied their Prophet's condemnation of monkery by building an abode for members of the order. The Sūfīs were strongly opposed to the idea of free-will or distinct and self-existent personality apart from the Beloved. The orthodox Muslim's idea was precisely the reverse. The Sūfīs have always made the Koran their text-book. With infinite licence they ingeniously quote therefrom, and still more ingeniously add their own explanations when necessary. No doubt there were political reasons for adopting this method of concealing heterodox ideas under the cloak of orthodoxy. We shall see, however, as the sect grew and still further broadened its views, that these clever compromises did not prevent the appear-

ance of martyrs among their number in the future.

By the end of the second century of the Hijira the Súfis were a much-respected religious order. In the following century Quietism had not only changed to Pantheism, but Pantheism had kindled a belief that Beloved and lover were identical. The step was inevitable and at this juncture it was that Súfism became essentially mystical, and it became more mystical as years advanced. About this time, viz., the beginning of the third century A.H., we come across two interesting Súfis who seem to have been the prime movers in this new development, by name Bayázid and Mansur al-Halláj.

Concerning the saint Bayázid an interesting story is told in the Fourth Book of the *Masnavi*. The saint surprised his disciples one day by saying: "Lo, I myself am God Almighty. There is no God beside me; worship me!" The disciples, thinking their Master was beside himself, told him, when the strange ecstasy had passed, what he had said. Bayázid promptly replied: "If I do so again straightway slay me!" His disciples accordingly sharpened their knives. Once more Bayázid cried out: "Within my vesture is naught but God, whether you seek Him on earth or heaven." The disciples, horror-struck at his remarks, straightway plunged their knives into Bayázid's body. But their blades

were turned back against their own throats, so that they died. He explained to the few disciples, who had not struck him, that the ecstasy he had been experiencing annihilated self, "His form is vanished, he is a mere mirror." The disciples who had struck him saw their own faces in that mirror and so wounded themselves, and not Bayázíd, whose soul had left the mirror of his body and was one with the Beloved.

Perhaps the life of Mansur al-Halláj is even more interesting. Whether he was a mere adventurer or genuine exponent of Súfism is still open to controversy among modern Súfis. It will be perfectly safe to describe him as either a saint or a vagabond. He was possibly both extremes to suit the necessities of a very exciting and eventful career. He was born in the close of the ninth century A.D., and was said to perform many miracles, such as raising the dead to life, and drawing gold and flowers from the air. According to his own belief he could write verses equal to those of the Koran. He went one better than the "superman" theory, however, and called himself God, and his disciples after the various prophets. Akbar was called God, but deification in this case did not sound from his own trumpet; it sounded from the trumpet of an enthusiastic poet: "See Akbar and you see God." Al-Halláj visited India for the purpose of studying magic, and there

saw the celebrated Rope Trick, on that occasion performed by a woman, a point of considerable interest.* This mystic-adventurer wrote forty-six books, and certainly gained considerable influence over the lower classes by his many signs and wonders. He is said to have disputed the necessity of making a pilgrimage to Mecca by stating that by occult practices it could be performed equally well in any room. On a certain occasion, however, we cannot help but admire Al-Halláj's wit and aptitude. One day he stretched forth an empty hand and produced from the air an apple, which he asserted he had plucked from Paradise. One of his witnesses disputed his assertion, because this particular apple was maggot-eaten, and therefore not of Divine origin. Al-Halláj at once replied: "It is because it hath come forth from the Mansion of Eternity to the Abode of Decay: therefore to its heart hath corruption found its way!"

Al-Halláj, on account of his various heretical teachings, was imprisoned and subjected to all manner of cruelties. Bravely he went forth to the place of crucifixion. For four days he was nailed on a cross on both sides of the Tigris. From these tortures he was finally released. Ten years later he was executed, telling his disciples

* "Among the Adepts and Mystics of Hindostan." *The Occult Review*, December, 1905.

he would return to them in thirty days, and exultantly reciting poetry, he cried: "From His own cup He bade me sup, for such is hospitality!" A comment of his on Súfiism—a very ironical one—was: "That which is mine, for by God I never distinguished for a moment between pleasure and pain!" Yet another characteristic saying of his was: "The way to God is two steps: one step out of this world and one step out of the next world, and lo! you are there with the Lord!" Whatever were the faults of Al-Halláj, and they were many, at least it may be said of him that he was a brave man. With all his fanaticism, his absurd indiscretion and love of conjuring, he left much behind of permanent value to the Súfis. The Government, in those days, did all in its power to restrain the publicity of his books; but a light that was never for a moment set under a bushel cannot be hid; the very attempt to obliterate it is in itself the cause for a keener and more persistent search.

In the fifth century of the Hijira we may note Abu-l-Khair as the first to give Súfiism politic significance, and Imān Ghazālī as the first to give it a metaphysical basis. At this time we find in Súfī books many terms borrowed from the Neo-Platonists. Books on ethics, as well as poetry, now became impregnated with Súfī ideas.

III. THE NATURE OF SUFÍISM

The Súfis are folk who have preferred God to everything, so that God has preferred them to everything.—DHU' L-NUN.*

IN the Islám faith there are eight Paradises arranged one within the other in ascending stages. The highest is called "The Garden of Eden." All are lovely gardens full of luxuriant flowers and trees, amid which gleam the domes and minarets of gorgeous palaces, rich with precious stones, where the departed are feasted and entertained by beautiful *houris*. All the Paradises are watered by rivers, such as the Kevser, the Tesnīm, and the Selsebíl. The great Tuba tree grows in the highest Paradise; its branches fall into the seven other gardens.† This brief description will be sufficient to show the nature of the Muslim heaven. That it was a glorified creation of the earth in eight degrees is evident. It was sensuous rather than metaphysical. The five worlds of the Súfis are :

1. The "Plane of the Absolute Invisible."
2. The "Relatively Invisible."
3. The "World of Similitudes."

* For further extracts from Sufi writers see *A Historical Enquiry concerning the Origin and Development of Sufism*, By R. A. Nicholson. *The Journal of the Royal Asiatic Society*, March, 1906.

† See *History of Ottoman Poetry*, by E. G. W. Gibb, vol. i.

4. The "Visible World" (or the plane of "Form, Generation and Corruption").

5. The "World of Man."

These Five Planes are often regarded as Three : the "Invisible," the "Intermediate," and the "Visible," or yet again as simply the "Visible" and "Invisible." Above the "Plane of the Absolute Invisible" is an infinity which we might, perhaps, compare with Dante's "Spaceless Empyrean." The Súfís regarded the existence of the soul as pre-natal. Moreover that the full perception of Earthly Beauty was the remembrance of that Supreme Beauty in the Spiritual world. The body was the veil ; but by ecstasy (*Hál*) the soul could behold the Divine Mysteries. As Avicenna, in his poem on the soul, has written :

Lo, it was hurled
Midst the sign-posts and ruined abodes of this desolate world.
It weeps, when it thinks of its home and the peace it possessed,
With tears welling forth from its eyes without pausing or rest,
And with plaintive mourning it broodeth like one bereft
O'er such trace of its home as the fourfold winds have left.

Creation was regarded as the output of the All-Beautiful. The visible world and all therein was a reflection of the Divine, an ever-changing scene full of the Spirit of God. The following beautiful poem of Jámí, from *Yúsuf-u-Zulaykhá*, will illustrate the Súfí's conception of the Beloved

and His significance and relationship to His world of lovers :

No mirror to reflect Its loveliness,
 Nor comb to touch Its locks ; the morning breeze
 Ne'er stirred Its tresses ; no collyrium
 Lent lustre to Its eyes ; no rosy cheeks
 O'ershadowed by dark curls like hyacinth,
 Nor peach-like down were there. . . .
 To Itself it sang of love
 In wordless measure. By Itself it cast
 The die of love. . . .
 One gleam fell from It on the Universe
 And on the angels, and this single ray
 Dazzled the angels, till their senses whirled
 Like the revolving sky. In diverse forms
 Each mirror showed it forth, and everywhere
 Its praise was chanted in new harmonies.

The spirits who explore the depths
 Of boundless seas, wherein the heavens swim
 Like some small boat, cried with one mighty voice,
 "Praise to the Lord of all the universe !"
 His beauty everywhere doth show itself,
 And through the forms of earthly beauties shines
 Obscured as through a veil. . . .
 Where'er thou seest a veil,
 Beneath that veil He hides. Whatever heart
 Doth yield to love, He charms it. In His love
 The heart hath life. Longing for Him, the soul
 Hath victory. *

Man was, therefore, a part of God, because he was a fragment of the Whole ; or, better still, he

* Translation by Professor E. G. Browne.

was a divine emanation.* The Súfí recognised this fact, and his supreme desire was to be reunited with the Beloved. His difficulty, however, was to bear in mind that his worship should ever be of God, and not of God's many beautiful forms. Love came into his heart, and he endeavoured to recognise that earthly objects, however dear and beautiful they might be, were but lanterns where God's Light shone through. Here it must be readily admitted that Súfism often fails. The Súfí poets were much given to excessive laudations of physical beauty, and we often find, with all the toleration and ingenuity we can bring to bear, that some of Háfiz's lines are no more spiritual than Anacreon's, to whom he has been compared. We have a number of Súfí words with a strictly Súfí meaning; but it would not be wise to strain the analogy of earthly love too far and say that everything that Háfiz wrote was spiritual. The Súfí poets, for the most part, wrote about the Love of God in the terms applied to their beautiful women, for the simple reason that no one can write the celestial language and be understood at the same time. Is it to be wondered at that the Súfis, still remembering their old love-songs, their old earthly delights in women dear to them,

* Compare the Alexandrian doctrine of Emanations. Also Jámi's *Lawā'ih*. Translated by E. H. Whinfield and Mūrza Muḥammad Kazvīnī.

24 THE MEANING OF SÚFÍ WORDS

should find it difficult *not* to apply such names, such ideas even in their love of the One Beloved? Take those expressions literally and many of them are sensuous, but consider them as brave, strong strivings, fraught with much spiritual fervour, after God, and you at once annihilate prejudice and come very near understanding the meaning of Súfiism. We need not fly to Mrs. Grundy and seek shelter under her hypocritical wing when some really devout and sincere Súfí calls God "the Eternal Darling" or sings about the Beloved's curls. In studying Súfiism from Súfí poetry we must always remember that Eastern poetry is essentially erotic in expression, but just as essentially symbolic in *meaning*. We must also bear in mind—and this point must have had its influence upon Súfiism—that the Muslim's reward for having lived a good life, according to the teaching of Mohammed, was that he should enjoy an eternal *liason* with lovely *houris*.

It may be questioned that if the earthly object of Love was a mere passing shadow of God, the man who loved that object was equally insignificant. And again, how can God be the All-One when, according to the Súfí thesis, He divided Himself into creation? The part is not equal to the whole. These questions are easily answered. The stars shine in the sky, and on the bosom of the sea without diminution.

Let the sea pass away, and the star-shadows pass away too ; but the stars are still there. So when the world shall pass away it will only be the fading of innumerable shadows we call Humanity. God will still be there, and we shall still be there because we came alone from Him. There was a Voice that sounded in men and women, in mountains and in seas, in the beasts of the jungle and the swinging of the stars. It was the Voice of Love, the great beckoning in the Hereafter to which all things must go. That Voice to the Súfí was God calling His lovers into one chamber, one mighty love-feast. Jámí has expressed the finality of Love in the following lines :

Gaze, till Gazing out of Gazing
Grew to BEING Her I gaze on,
She and I no more, but in One
Undivided Being blended.
All that is not One must ever
Suffer with the Wound of Absence ;
And whoever in Love's City
Enters, finds but Room for One,
And but in ONENESS Union.

The Rev. Professor W. R. Inge, in *Christian Mysticism*, has brought a good deal of adverse criticism to bear upon Súfíism. He remarks: "The Súfís, or Mohammedan Mystics, use erotic language very freely, and appear, like true Asiastics, to have attempted to give a sacramental or symbolic

character to the indulgence of their passions." The same writer accuses Emerson of "playing with pantheistic Mysticism of the Oriental type," and goes on to compare him with the Persian Súfís on account of his self-deification. This critic, in his desire to defame the Súfís, states that they are among the most shocking and blasphemous of the mystics, because they believe that state is present with them even in their earthly life. This, however, is no teaching of the Súfís, and, rightly considered, we cannot even except the sayings of Bayázíd already referred to, because here he undoubtedly denies all claim to human personality, admitting God only. *Self-deification* is no teaching of the Súfís. As the Buddhist's belief in Nirvana was a state only to be reached by degrees, after much striving and severe discipline, so was the fusion of the Beloved and His lover a belief and a beautiful hope far out on the spiritual horizon. Hadj Khan, in his interesting book *With the Pilgrims to Mecca*, briefly touches upon this sect and mentions "seven stages" in the spiritual growth of the Súfí, and not an arrogant proclamation of Deity and man being coequal in the earthly existence. The gradually ascending scale of the Súfí's heaven is another point in favour of this argument. "For the love that thou would'st find demands the sacrifice of self to the end that the heart may be filled with the passion to stand

within the Holy of Holies, in which alone the mysteries of the True Beloved can be revealed unto thee." The average Súfí was a poet. All that was beautiful was God to him. He tried to be nearer the Beautiful every day, and thus his soul swept on from flower to flower, higher and higher, until he was absorbed into the Divine.

We have now seen that Súfíism is essentially a religion of Love without a creed or dogma. No merciless hells leap up in the Súfí's beliefs. He has no *one way* theory for the Life beyond: "The ways of God are as the number of the souls of men." There is splendid, magnificent broad-mindedness in this Súfí remark. This unsectarian teaching should be applied to every religion. It would tend to sweeten and deepen the thoughts of men, who would forget the petty non-essentials of creeds and dogmas, lost in the perception of the All-Beautiful.

IV. THE INFLUENCE OF SÚFÍISM

This love here forms the centre which expands on all sides and into all regions.—HEGEL.

ALTHOUGH Jalálu'd-Dín Rúmí lived for fifty years in a Turkish city he scarcely ever used any Turkish words; but nevertheless his influence on Turkish poetry was very considerable. The

28 INFLUENCE IN TURKEY AND INDIA

Turkish poets of that day poured forth innumerable "spiritual couplets" of a mystical nature. Indeed nearly all the Ottoman poets were either Súfis or men who wrote after the manner of the Persian Súfis. Jalál's son, Sultan Valad, wrote in Turkish the following concerning his father :

Wot ye well Mevláná is of saints the Pole ;
Whatsoever thing he sayeth, do in whole.
All his words are mercies from the Heavenly King ;
Such that blind folks' eyes were opened, did they sing.

The Súfí influence on Turkish poetry, many years after Jalál's death, gradually weakened as time went on, and their poetry became less mystical. The French were probably responsible for this change to a certain extent.

Then, again, Súfiism influenced the poetry of India ; but in this case there was influence on both sides, and the Súfis probably borrowed some of the Buddhistic ideas, especially in regard to their later conception of Divine absorption. The following remark of Abú Bahu al-Shiblí certainly points to the belief that the Súfis inculcated certain ideas from the Vedanta Philosophy :—" *Tasawwuf* is control of the faculties and observance of the breaths."

Súfí poetry has greatly influenced Western thought. Many of the German mystics wrote as the Súfí poets had written before them. Particularly might be mentioned Eckhart, Tauler

and Suso. Concerning the last mentioned I may quote the following passage to demonstrate my meaning : "Earthly friends must needs endure to be distinct and separate from those whom they love ; but Thou, O fathomless sweetness of all true love, meltest into the heart of Thy beloved, and pourest Thyself fully into the essence of his soul, that nothing of Thee remains outside, but Thou art joined and united most lovingly with Thy beloved." There was rapturous language both with the Persian and German mystics. The great difference between them was that the German mystics, for the most part, were ascetics, the Persians were not. Then again in the nineteenth century Hegel was loud in his praise of Jalálu'd-Dín Rúmí, calling him a great thinker as well as a great poet, but somehow he seems to put Jalál's Pantheism first, his Mysticism second. Surely this was putting the cart before the horse ?

To trace the scope of the influence of Súfí thought in England would be extremely interesting, but the limits of this little book will not admit of our doing so. The influence was at first among the few ; but optimistic lovers of the East believe that Oriental thought is daily becoming of more interest to Western minds. The student knows that Edward FitzGerald's rendering of Omar Khayyám was anything but a faithful translation ; that FitzGerald shook

up Omar's words like so many dice and set them to the music of wine, roses, and pessimism. The Omar Khayyám Club read FitzGerald, but not Omar Khayyám, and in consequence they have fallen into the error of associating Omar with Bacchus. But, nevertheless, we must be grateful to FitzGerald. He has given us a great poem, and stirred, let us hope, many of his countless readers to a more faithful study of Persian poetry. The indefatigable Dr. Johnson has written the following on the Persian poet, who is the subject of our present volume: "He makes plain to the Pilgrim the secrets of the Way of Unity, and unveils the Mysteries of the Path of Eternal Truth." Concerning our modern poets I have quoted elsewhere a few lines of Mr. Arthur Symonds on a dancing dervish. Many of the late Thomas Lake Harris's poems are of a Súfí nature. In Mr. Stephen Phillip's beautiful poem "Marpessa," the following lines are full of Súfí mysticism:

For they,
Seeking that perfect face beyond the world,
Approach in vision earthly semblances,
And touch, and at the shadows flee away.

It is interesting to note that at least one celebrated Englishman adopted the Súfí teaching. I refer to Sir Richard Burton.* The Súfís believed

* *Life of Sir Richard Burton*. 2 vols. By Thomas Wright.

heart and soul in the beautiful lines of Cameons, the poet for whom Burton had so great an affection :

Do what thy manhood bids thee do, from none but self
expect applause.

He noblest lives and noblest dies who makes and keeps his
self-made laws.

All other life is living death, a world where none but
phantoms dwell ;

A breath, a wind, a sound, a voice, a tinkling of the camel-
bell.

V. ANALYSIS OF THE RELIGION OF LOVE

Put away the tale of love that travellers tell ;
Do thou serve God with all thy might.

JALÁLU'D-DÍN RÚMÍ.

SÚFÍSM, then, is the religion of Love. Lafcadio Hearn tells us, in his inimitable way, that earthly love is brought about by the memories of innumerable loves in the past, a host of the phantoms of you seeking in your momentary ego the joy of Love over again. Schopenhauer, with much pride, quotes Rochefoucauld as having said that "love may be compared to a ghost since it is something we talk about but have never seen." Precisely ; but this is no antagonistic statement, as Schopenhauer supposed. Rather than belittling the beauty of Love, it is an unconscious defence of a very great truth.

Love can only be compared with Love. There is nothing else to compare it with. No one has seen Love, because no one has seen God. A little child plays at funerals and tenderly buries a dead butterfly, not because it understands the mystery of Death, but because Love prompted the action. And so we love without knowing the why and the wherefore. Scientists have already proved that first love is not controlled by either of the individuals loving; that it is but the expression of thousands of tendencies in past lives. That Love can be ever personal, ever limited to the individual, is unthinkable. We must recognise some day that those countless tendencies, those strivings after men and women seeming to hold our souls' affinities, were but the momentary finding of God in His creatures. We do not love a woman merely because she is pretty, possesses a pleasing mannerism. We love her because, in an indescribable way, she sings a song we alone can fully understand, a voice that lifts up our soul and makes it strong. We follow that Invisible Figure from land to land, from heart to heart, from Death into Life, on and on. When Love loves Love for its own sake, when the self is dead, we shall meet Him. We shall find the Beloved to be the Perfection, the realisation of that strong desire that made us lose ourselves in others. The more we lose ourselves in God the more we find Him. Men and women

love and die. But Love is a Divine Essence working through and through innumerable lives for its own eternal glory. Personality is limited only to the finite world—perhaps a phase or two beyond the grave. Even that is the sum-total of countless so-called personalities in the past. We love instinctively. If it was wholly physical then it dies with the death of the object. If it was infinitely more than that, if it was the love of Goodness and Purity and the Beautiful it lives on for ever. But these things live not eternally in humanity. They are parts of that all-pervading Essence—the Love Divine. Love God's light in men and women, and not the lanterns through which It shines, for human bodies must turn to dust; human memories, human desires, fade away. But the love of the All-Good, All-Beautiful remains, and when such is found in earthly love it is God finding Himself in you, and you in Him. That is the supreme teaching of Súfiism, the religion of Love.

THE LIFE AND WORK OF JALÁLU'D-DÍN RÚMÍ

I. LIFE

JALÁLU'D-DÍN RÚMÍ was born at Balkh on September 30th, 1207, A.D., or according to Mohammedan reckoning, in 604 A.H. His father, Bahaū-'d-Dín, was a man of much learning, but gave offence to the reigning king by an attack on that monarch's innovations. Another account disputes this in the place of jealousy on the part of the king. Whatever the cause, however, Bahaū-'d-Dín left Balkh, together with his family, and settled at Nishapur. It was here that the celebrated Súfī, Farīdu-d Dīn 'Attār, presented young Jalálu'd-Dín-Rúmí with his *Asrarnama*,* and informed his father that the child would some day become famous throughout the world. After the destruction of Balkh the family went to Qonia,† an old Roman province, where the poet acquired his name Rúmí, or

* *Book of Mysteries.*

† Iconium.

“the Roman.” Young Jalál must have been a child prodigy if we are to believe the many wonderful stories of his early days. At six years of age he is said to have seen visions, taught his playmates philosophy, and performed many marvellous feats, such as flying into the celestial regions. On the death of his father Jalál took the professorial chair. He also founded an order of Dervishes known as Maulavis, where he authorised music and religious dance. When asked why he introduced singing and dance at a funeral, such practice being contrary to custom, Jalál replied: “When the human spirit, after years of imprisonment in the cage and dungeon of the body, is at length set free, and wings its flight to the Source whence it came, is not this an occasion for rejoicings, thanks, and dancing?” Jalál was an indomitable optimist. In his sayings, and still more in his poetry, we find an almost untrammelled ecstasy. The religious dances, known as Rizā Kulī, may in some way account for Jalál’s occasional lack of care displayed in his poetry, and also for the outbursts not far removed from insanity. We are informed by Daulat Sháh that “There was a pillar in the Maulavi’s house, and when he was drowned in the ocean of Love he used to take hold of that pillar and set himself turning round it.” It was while turning round the pillar that he not infrequently dictated much

of his poetry. As Mr. Arthur Symons has sung :

I turn until my sense,
Dizzied with waves of air,
Spins to a point intense,
And spires and centres there.*

We can well imagine Jalál writing the following under the conditions just mentioned :

Come! Come! Thou art the Soul, the Soul so dear,
revolving!
Come! Come! Thou art the Cedar, the Cedar's Spear,
revolving!
Oh, come! The well of Light up-bubbling springs;
And Morning Stars exult, in Gladness sheer, revolving!" †

In 1226 A.D. Jalál was married at Lerenda to Gevher (Pearl). She bore two sons and died early in life. Jalál married again and his second wife survived him.

II. SHAMSI TABRÍZ

A WORD must now be said about Shamsi Tabriz, an intimate friend of Jalál. We have sufficient evidence to prove that Shamsi Tabriz, Jalál's

* *The Fool of the World.*

† *The Festival of Spring.* Translated by the Rev. Prof. William Hastie.

nom de guerre, was an actual person, and not a mythical creation on the part of the poet. This mysterious being, who flitted across Jalál's life so tragically, seems to have had great personal influence over the poet, who went with him into solitary places and there discussed profound mysteries. The scholars of Jalál looked upon the whole affair as an unworthy infatuation on the part of their Master, and on the part of Shams a shameful seduction. Their protests brought about the flight of Shams, who fled to Tabrīz. But it was only a momentary separation. Jalál followed this strange figure and brought him back again. Most of his lighter poetry was composed during this separation. Another disturbance, however, caused the departure of Shams to Damascus. We then have no clear record of him. Various legends exist in regard to the death of this mysterious person. It may be safely stated, however, that Shams met with a violent death, the exact nature of which it is impossible to say definitely.

This strange union is by no means unique in the history of the world's literature. The union, however, in this particular case, is extremely difficult to rightly fathom. We may reasonably infer that Jalál's intense poetic temperament became fascinated by the dogmatic and powerful Shams. The very treatment of this friendship, both in the *Lyrical Poems*, and in the *Masnavi*,

38 THE STORIES OF AL-AFLAKI

is Súfí. The two following quotations, from many that might be cited, will prove sufficient to illustrate this point :

The face of Shamsi Din, Tabriz's glory, is the sun
In whose track the cloud-like hearts are moving.

O Shamsi Tabriz, beauty and glory of the horizons,
What king but is a beggar of thee with heart and soul ?

III. THE STORIES OF AL-AFLÁKÍ AND THE DEATH OF JALÁLU'D-DÍN RÚMÍ.*

THE historian al-Aflákí, in his collection of anecdotes called *Menaqibu 'L 'Arifin*,† gives a number of stories relating to the miracles and wise sayings of Jalál. Many of these miraculous performances were followed by the conversion of those who witnessed them. A marvel or a wise saying of Jalál was generally accompanied by music and dance, which reminds us of the jubilations of the Indian gods after Rama's victories over his enemies. These stories, interesting enough in themselves, can scarcely be credited to such a learned man as Jalál undoubtedly was. According to tradition he spoke to frogs and fishes, raised the dead to life, and at the same time

* See *The Masnavi*. Translated by Sir James W. Red house.

† "The Acts of the Adepts."

very ignominiously lost his temper when a disciple who said, after having received Jalál's instructions : "God willing." After all, the significance of Jalál lies not in these rather lamentable fairy tales, but in the fruit of his work. Jalál, like the Lord Buddha, suffered considerably from the addition of fabulous tales and fancies of no real moment to his teachings.

Al-Aflākī tells a pretty story concerning the tenderness of Jalál for little children. As the poet passed by some children, they left their play and ran to him and bowed. Jalál bowed in response. One little boy, some distance off, seeing the honour bestowed upon his playmates, cried to Jalál : "Wait for me until I come !" And Jalál waited and bowed to the little child. This story is worth far more than juggler's tricks.

Jalálu'd-Dín Rúmi died at Qonia in 1273 A.D., praising God and leaving to the world a vast store of spiritual knowledge and many wise instructions to his son, Bahau'd-Din Valad. It is very gratifying to note that at the death of Jalál his mourners were of all creeds. A Christian was asked why he wept over a Muslim grave, and he replied : "We esteem him as the Moses, the David, the Jesus of our time ; and we are his disciples, his adherents." This was indeed a splendid and worthy tribute to the memory of so great a man.

I hope I have already demonstrated that the very nature of Súfí poetry is entirely lacking in creed or dogma, and certainly the great singer of the *Masnavi* has left in his songs a wealth of the wonder of Divine Love.

IV. THE NATURE AND SIGNIFICANCE OF JALÁLU'D-DÍN RÚMÍ'S POETRY

The Lyrical.—We have already noted the acceptance of the *Asrarnama*. Among the other literary influences, according to Mr. Nicholson, we may note the poems of Sana'i, Sa'di, and Nizami. The fact that Jalál's poetry sometimes faintly resembles Omar Khayyám's is too slight to be of any value. Mr. Nicholson very ably sums up the nature of the *Masnavi* and *Divan* respectively: "The one is a majestic river, calm and deep, meandering through many a rich and varied landscape to the immeasurable ocean; the other a foaming torrent that leaps and plunges in the ethereal solitude of the hills." The poetry of Jalál is not of equal merit. His work seldom if ever has the technical polish of Jami. There is too much of it; too much produced in the belief that all his poetry was inspired. He is fond of harping on certain words, and as far as the translations are concerned he has little

sense of humour.* There was certainly room for a touch of humour in the poet's description of Iblis receiving from God a gift of beautiful women whereby to tempt mankind; but Jalál entirely ignores it. These weaknesses are almost lost in the strength and purity and lyrical grandeur of many of Jalál's poems. He carries us along on a torrent of heavenly music. The rhythmic swing of his wonderful dance is soul-stirring. We seem to move exultantly, ecstatically, to the sound of the poet's singing, far behind the silver stars into the Presence of the Beloved. With what reverence, with what a glow of simile and subtle suggestion he describes the Beauty of the Beloved! With what exquisite passion he foretells the Eternal Union! Then there is a lull in this fierce spiritual song, and Jalál sings, ever so gently and with an infinite tenderness, about human tears being turned into "rain-clouds." He sings about the meeting of two friends in Paradise, with the oft-repeated refrain, "Thou and I." There seems in this poem an indescribable and almost pathetic play on the idea of human friendship and the Divine Friendship, a yearning tenderness for that human shadow, passing shadow though it be. Jalál appears to have the power of

* Prof. C. E. Wilson informs me that Jalál certainly had a very fair sense of humour, and that in the original there is often a clever and witty play on words.

producing almost orchestral effects in his music of the Spheres. There is that terrific touch of Wagner about his poetry, and in those suggestive Wagner-pauses there is a tenderness of expression more touching, more truly great than the loud triumphant notes. Jalál has truly said: "Our journey is to the Rose-Garden of Union." He sang about the Divine Rose-Garden; but he did not forget to sing about the roses that fade and the human hearts that ache. We seem to see Jalál ever bowing to the little child in all his wonderful singing.

The Masnavi.—Jalál is said to have been forty-three years engaged in writing the *Masnavi*. Often whole nights were spent in its composition, Jalál reciting and his friend Hasam copying it down and sometimes singing portions of the verse in his beautiful voice. At the completion of the first book Hasam's wife died, and two years elapsed before the work was continued. The *Masnavi* is full of profound mysteries, and is a most important book in the study of Súfíism—mysteries which must, for the most part, be left to the discernment of the reader. Jalál himself has said that great Love is silent. It is in Silence that we shall come to understand the supreme Mystery of Love that has no comparison. The key-note to the *Masnavi* may be found in the Prologue to the first book. The poet here sings of the soul's longing to be united

THE KEY-NOTE TO THE "MASNAVI" 43

with the Beloved. The fact that he, and all other Súfí poets, use as an analogy the love between man and woman renders the spiritual meaning extremely vague. We have, however, already considered this point in the introduction, and it needs no further explanation. The *Masnavi* has all the pantheistic beauty of the Psalms, the music of the hills, the colour and scent of roses, the swaying of forests ; but it has considerably more than that. These things of scent and form and colour are the Mirror of the Beloved ; these earthy loves the journey down the valley into the Rose-Garden where the roses never fade, and where Love is.

SELECTIONS FROM THE "DĪVĀNĪ SHAMSI TABRĪZ"

" I AM SILENT "

I am silent. Speak Thou, O Soul of Soul of Soul,
From desire of whose Face every atom grew
articulate.

A CRY TO THE BELOVED

Yestereve I delivered to a star tidings for thee :
" Present," I said, " my service to that moon-
like form."

I bowed, I said : " Bear that service to the sun
Who maketh hard rocks gold by his burning."

I bared my breast, I showed it the wounds :

" Give news of me," I said, " to the Beloved
whose drink is blood."

I rocked to and fro that the child, my heart,
might become still ;

A child sleeps when one sways the cradle.

REMEMBER GOD AND FORGET SELF 45

Give my heart-babe milk, relieve us from its
weeping,
O Thou that helpest every moment a hundred
helpless like me.
The heart's home, first to last, is Thy City of
Union :
How long wilt Thou keep in exile this heart
forlorn ?

REMEMBER GOD AND FORGET SELF

O spirit, make thy head in search and seeking
like the water of a stream,
And O reason, to gain Eternal Life tread ever-
lastingly the way of Death.
Keep God in remembrance till self is forgotten,
That thou may be lost in the Called, without
distraction of caller and call.

" THE PRINCE OF THE FAIR "

A garden—may its rose be in flower to Resurrec-
tion !
An idol—may the two worlds be scattered o'er
his beauty !
The Prince of the Fair goes proudly forth to the
chase at morning ;
May our hearts fall a prey to the arrow of His
glance !

46 "MY BODY IS LIKE THE MOON"

From His eye what messages are passing continually to mine !

May my eyes be gladdened and filled with intoxication by His Message !

"MY BODY IS LIKE THE MOON"

My body is like the moon which is melting for Love,

My heart like Zuhra's * lute—may its strings be broken !

Look not on the moon's waning nor on Zuhra's broken state :

Behold the sweetness of his affection—may it wax a thousandfold !

MORTALITY AND IMMORTALITY

What a Bride is in the soul ! By the reflection of Her face

May the world be freshened and coloured like the hands of the newly married ! †

Look not on the fleshy cheek which corrupts and decays,

Look on the spiritual cheek—may it be sweet and agreeable !

* The celestial Venus, and leader of the starry choirs to music. See R. A. Nicholson's note in *Selected Poems from the Dīvāni Shamsi Tabrīz*.

† A design traced in henna.

The dark body resembles a raven, and the body's
world winter ;
O in spite of these two unpleasants may there
be Eternal Spring !

THE BELOVED THE DIVINE CONSOLER

O Thou who art my soul's comfort in the season
of sorrow,
O Thou who art my spirit's treasure in the
bitterness of dearth !
That which the imagination has not conceived,
that which the understanding has not seen,
Visited my soul from Thee ; hence in worship
I turn toward Thee.
By Thy grace I keep fixed on Eternity my amorous
gaze,
Except, O King, the pomps that perish lead me
astray.
The favour of that one, who brings glad tidings
of Thee,
Even without Thy summons, is sweeter in mine
ear than songs.

.

If a never-ceasing bounty should offer kingdoms,
If a hidden treasure should set before me all
that is,
I would bend down my soul, I would lay my face
in the dust,

I would say, "Of all these the love of such an
One for me !"

"THOU ART THE SOUL OF THE WORLD"

Eternal Life, methinks, is the time of Union,
Because Time, for me, hath no place There.
Life is the vessels, Union the clear draught in
them ;
Without Thee what does the pain of the vessels
avail me ?
I had twenty thousand desires ere this ;
In passion for Him not even (care of) my safety
remained.
By the help of His grace I am become safe,
because
The unseen King saith to me, "Thou art the
soul of the world."

"THE VOICE OF LOVE"

Every moment the voice of Love is coming from
left and right.
We are bound for heaven : who has a mind to
sight-seeing ?
We have been in heaven, we have been friends
of the angels ;
Thither, Sire, let us return, for that is our country.

THE MOON-SOUL AND THE SEA 53

I went to the idol-temple, to the ancient pagoda ;
No trace was visible there.

I went to the mountains of Herāt and Candahār ;
I looked ; He was not in that hill-and-dale.

.

I gazed into my own heart ;
There I saw Him ; He was nowhere else.

GOD ONLY

“ None but God has contemplated the beauty of
God.”

This eye and that lamp are two lights, each
individual,

When they came together, no one distinguished
them.

THE MOON-SOUL AND THE SEA

At morning-tide a moon appeared in the sky,
And descended from the sky and gazed on me.
Like a falcon which snatches a bird at the time
of hunting,

That moon snatched me up and coursed over
the sky.

When I looked at myself, I saw myself no more,
Because in that moon my body became by grace
even as soul.

When I travelled in soul, I saw naught save the
moon;
Till the secret of the Eternal Theophany was
revealed.
The nine spheres of heaven were all merged in
that moon,
The vessel of my being was completely hidden in
the sea.
The sea broke into waves, and again Wisdom rose
And cast abroad a voice ; so it happened and
thus it befell.
Foamed the sea, and at every foam-fleck
Something took figure and something was bodied
forth.
Every foam-fleck of body, which received a sign
from that sea,
Melted straightway and turned to spirit in this
Ocean.

LIFE IN DEATH

When my bier moveth on the day of Death,
Think not my heart is in this world.
Do not weep in the devil's snare : that is woe.
When thou seest my hearse, cry not " Parted,
parted ! "
Union and meeting are mine in that hour.
If thou commit me to the grave, say not " Fare-
well, farewell ! "

For the grave is a curtain hiding the communion
of Paradise,

After beholding descent, consider resurrection ;

Why should setting be injurious to the sun and
moon ?

To thee it seems a setting, but 'tis a rising ;

Tho' the vault seems a prison, 'tis the release
of the soul.

.

Shut thy mouth on this side and open it beyond,
For in placeless air will be thy triumphal song.

THE WHOLE AND THE PART

Beware ! do not keep, in a circle of reprobates,
Thine eye shut like a bud, thy mouth open like
the rose.

The world resembles a mirror : thy Love is the
perfect image :

O people, who has ever seen a part greater than
the whole ?

THE DIVINE FRIEND

Look on me, for thou art my companion in
the grave

On the night when thou shalt pass from shop
and dwelling.

Thou shalt hear my hail in the hollow of the
tomb : it shall become known to thee
That thou wast never concealed from mine eye.
I am as reason and intellect within thy bosom
At the time of joy and gladness, at the time of
sorrow and distress.

In the hour when the intellectual lamp is lighted,
What a pean goes up from the dead men in the
tombs !

ASPIRATION

Haste, haste ! for we too, O soul, are coming
From this world of severance to that world of
Union.

O how long shall we, like children, in the earthly
sphere

Fill our lap with dust and stones and sherds ?
Let us give up the earth and fly heavenwards,
Let us flee from childhood to the banquet of
men.

Behold how the earthly frame has entrapped
thee !

Rend the sack and raise thy head clear.

“ I WILL CHERISH THE SOUL ”

“ I am a painter, a maker of pictures ; every
moment I shape a beauteous form,
And then in Thy presence I melt them all away.

I call up a hundred phantoms and indue them
with a spirit ;
When I behold Thy phantom, I cast them in the
fire."

Lo ! I will cherish the soul, because it has a
perfume of Thee.

Every drop of blood which proceeds from me
is saying to Thy dust :

" I am one colour with Thy love, I am a partner
of Thy affection."

In the house of water and clay this heart is
desolate without Thee ;

O Beloved, enter the house, or I will leave it.

" THIS IS LOVE "

This is Love : to fly heavenward,
To rend, every instant, a hundred veils.
The first moment, to renounce Life :
The last step, to feel without feet.
To regard this world as invisible,
Not to see what appears to one's self.
" O heart," I said, " may it bless thee
To have entered the circle of lovers,
To look beyond the range of the eye,
To penetrate the windings of the bosom !
Whence did this breath come to thee, O my soul,
Whence this throbbing, O my heart ? "

THE JOURNEY TO THE BELOVED

O lovers, O lovers, it is time to abandon the world :

The drum of departure reaches my spiritual ear from heaven.

Behold, the driver has risen and made ready his files of camels,

And begged us to acquit him of blame : why, O travellers, are you asleep ?

These sounds before and behind are the din of departure and of the camel-bells ;

With each moment a soul and spirit is setting off into the Void.

From these inverted candles, from these blue awnings

There has come forth a wondrous people, that the mysteries may be revealed.

A heavy slumber fell upon thee from the circling spheres :

Alas, for this life so light, beware of this slumber so heavy !

O soul, seek the Beloved, O friend, seek the Friend,

O watchman, be wakeful : it behoves not a watchman to sleep.

THE DAY OF RESURRECTION

On every side is clamour and tumult, in every street are candles and torches,

THE RETURN OF THE BELOVED 59

For to-night the teeming world gives birth to the
World Everlasting.

Thou wert dust and art spirit, thou wert ignorant
and art wise.

He who has led thee thus far will lead thee
further also.

How pleasant are the pains He makes thee suffer
while He gently draws thee to Himself!

THE RETURN OF THE BELOVED

Always at night returns the Beloved : do not
eat opium to-night ;

Close your mouth against food, that you may
taste the sweetness of the mouth.

Lo, the cup-bearer is no tyrant, and in his as-
sembly there is a circle :

Come into the circle, be seated ; how long will
you regard the revolution (of Time) ?

Why, when God's earth is so wide, have you
fallen asleep in a prison ?

Avoid entangled thoughts, that you may see
the explanation of Paradise.

Refrain from speaking, that you may win speech
hereafter.

Abandon life and the world, that you may behold
the Life of the world.

THE CALL OF THE BELOVED

Every morning a voice comes to thee from
heaven :

“When thou lay’st the dust of the way, thou
win’st thy way to the goal.”

On the road to the Ka’ba of Union, lo, in every
thorn-bush

Are thousands slain of desire who manfully
yielded up their lives.

Thousands sank wounded on this path, to whom
there came not

A breath of the fragrance of Union, a token from
the neighbourhood of the Friend.

“THE BANQUET OF UNION”

In memory of the banquet of Union, in yearning
for His beauty

They are fallen bewildered by the wine Thou
knowest.

How sweet, in the hope of Him, on the threshold
of His Abode,

For the sake of seeing His face, to bring night
round to day !

Illumine thy bodily senses by the Light of the
soul :

.

Look not in the world for bliss and fortune,
since thou wilt not find them ;

And the spring found earth in mourning, all
 naked, lone, and bare.
 I heard Time's loom a-whirring that wove the
 Sun's dim Veil ;
 I saw a worm a-weaving in Life-threads its own
 lair.
 I saw the Great was Smallest, and saw the
 Smallest Great ;
 For God had set His likeness on all the things
 that were.

" LOVE SOUNDS THE MUSIC OF THE SPHERES "

O, soul, if thou, too, wouldst be free,
 Then love the Love that shuts thee in.
 'Tis Love that twisteth every snare ;
 'Tis Love that snaps the bond of sin ;
 Love sounds the Music of the Spheres ;
 Love echoes through Earth's harshest din.

The world is God's pure mirror clear,
 To eyes when free from clouds within.
 With Love's own eyes the Mirror view,
 And there see God to self akin.

" THE SOULS LOVE-MOVED "

The souls love-moved are circling on,
 Like streams to their great Ocean King.

66 THE BELOVED ALL IN ALL

Thou art the Sun of all men's thoughts ;
Thy kisses are the flowers of spring.
The dawn is pale from yearning Love ;
The moon in tears is sorrowing.
Thou art the Rose, and deep for Thee,
In sighs, the nightingales still sing.

THE BELOVED ALL IN ALL

My Soul sends up to Heaven each night the cry
of Love !
God's starry Beauty draws with might the cry
of Love !
Bright sun and moon each morn dance in my
Heart at Dawn :
And waking me at daylight, excite the cry of
Love !
On every meadow glancing, I see God's sun-
beams play ;
And all Creation's wonders excite the cry of
Love !

I, All in All becoming, now clear see God in All ;
And up from Union yearning, takes flight the
cry of Love !

“ THOU AND I ”

Happy the moment when we are seated in the
Palace, thou and I,

That face which is bright as the forenoon sun—
To disfigure it were a grievous sin.

'Twere paganism to mar such a face as thine !
The moon itself would weep to lose sight of it !
Knowest thou not the beauty of thine own face ?
Quit this temper that leads thee to war with
thyself !

It is the claws of thine own foolish thoughts
That in spite wound the face of thy quiet soul.
Know such thoughts to be claws fraught with
poison.

Which score deep wounds on the face of thy soul.

THE DEVIL MAKES USE OF THE BEAUTY OF WOMEN

Thus spake cursed Iblis to the Almighty,
“ I want a mighty trap to catch human game
withal ! ”

God gave him gold and silver and troops and
horses,

Saying, “ You can catch my creatures with
these.”

Iblis said, “ Bravo ! ” but at the same time hung
his lip,

And frowned sourly like a bitter orange.

Then God offered gold and jewels from precious
mines

To that laggard in the faith,

Saying, “ Take these other traps, O cursed one.”

But Iblis said, "Give me more, O blessed Defender."

God gave him succulent and sweet and costly wines,

And also store of silken garments.

But Iblis said, "O Lord, I want more aids than these,

In order to bind men in my twisted rope.

So firmly that Thy adorers, who are valiant men,
May not, man-like, break my bonds asunder."

When at last God showed him the beauty of women,

Which bereaves men of reason and self-control,

Then Iblis clapped his hands and began to dance,

Saying, "Give me these; I shall quickly prevail
with these!" *

"LOVERS AND BELOVED HAVE BOTH PERISHED"

Lovers and beloved have both perished;

And not themselves only, but their love as well.

'Tis God alone who agitates these nonentities,

Making one nonentity fall in love with another.

* The meaning of this poem is strictly allegorical. We must not infer that the All-Good would be a party to the evil designs of the Devil. No material gifts, however seductive, could succeed in stamping out the Divine Presence in His creatures.

In the heart that is no heart envy comes to a
head,
Thus Being troubles nonentity.*

“ O ANGELS, BRING HIM BACK TO ME ”

“ O angels, bring him back to me.
Since the eyes of his heart were set on Hope,
Without care for consequence I set him free,
And draw the pen through the record of his
sins ! ”

SELF-AGGRANDISEMENT AND VAINGLORY
NO PART OF LOVE

A lover was once admitted to the presence of his mistress, but, instead of embracing her, he pulled out a paper of sonnets and read them to her, describing her perfections and charms and his own love towards her at length. His mistress said to him, “ You are now in my presence, and these lovers’ sighs and invocations are a waste of time. It is not the part of a true lover to waste his time in this way. It shows that I am not the real object of your affection, but

* At first sight there seems to be Omarian pessimism in this poem. In reality it signifies that all Love is One, which shines through the ever-vanishing lanterns of the world.

that what you really love is your own effusions and ecstatic raptures. I see, as it were, the water which I have longed for before me, and yet you withhold it. I am, as it were, in Bulgaria, and the object of your love is in Cathay. One who is really loved is the single object of her lover, the Alpha and Omega of his desires. As for you, you are wrapped up in your own amorous raptures, depending on the varying states of your own feelings, instead of being wrapped up in me."

"I AM THINE, AND THOU ART MINE !"

Eternal Life is gained by utter abandonment of one's own life. When God appears to His ardent lover the lover is absorbed in Him, and not so much as a hair of the lover remains. True lovers are as shadows, and when the sun shines in glory the shadows vanish away. He is a true lover to God to whom God says, "I am thine, and thou art Mine !"

LOVE NEEDS NO MEDIATOR

When one has attained Union with God he has no need of intermediaries. Prophets and apostles are needed as links to connect ordinary man with God, but he who hears the "inner voice" within him has no need to listen to out-

ward words, even of apostles. Although that intercession is himself dwelling in God, yet my state is higher and more lovely than his. Though he is God's agent, yet I desire not his intercession to save me from evil sent me by God, for evil at God's hand seems to me good. What seems mercy and kindness to the vulgar seems wrath and vengeance to God-intoxicated saints.

HUMANITY THE REFLECTION OF THE BELOVED

Parrots are taught to speak without understanding the words. The method is to place a mirror between the parrot and the trainer. The trainer, hidden by the mirror, utters the words, and the parrot, seeing his own reflection in the mirror, fancies another parrot is speaking, and imitates all that is said by the trainer behind the mirror. So God uses prophets and saints as mirrors whereby to instruct men, viz., the bodies of these saints and prophets; and men, when they hear the words proceeding from these mirrors, are utterly ignorant that they are really being spoken by "Universal Reason" or the "Word of God" behind the mirror of the saints.

"EARTHLY FORMS"

Earthly forms are only shadows of the Sun of Truth—a cradle for babes, but too small to hold those who have grown to spiritual manhood.

"THE BEATIFIC VISION OF ETERNAL TRUTH"

The end and object of all negation is to attain to subsequent affirmation, as the negation in the creed, "There is no God," finds its complement and purpose in the affirmation "but God." Just so the purpose of negation of self is to clear the way for the apprehension of the fact that there is no existence but the One. The intoxication of Life and its pleasures and occupations veils the Truth from men's eyes, and they ought to pass on to the spiritual intoxication which makes men beside themselves and lifts them to the beatific vision of eternal Truth.

THE WINE EVERLASTING

O babbler, while thy soul is drunk with mere
date wine,
Thy spirit hath not tasted the genuine grapes.
For the token of thy having seen that divine
Light
Is this, to withdraw thyself from the house of
pride.

BE LOST IN THE BEAUTY OF THE BELOVED

When those Egyptian women sacrificed their
reason,
They penetrated the mansion of Joseph's love ;

The Cup-bearer of Life bore away their reason,
They were filled with wisdom of the world with-
out end.

Joseph's beauty was only an offshoot of God's
beauty :

Be lost, then, in God's beauty more than those
women.

“ WHAT EAR HAS TOLD YOU FALSELY ”

What ear has told you falsely eye will tell truly.
Then ear, too, will acquire the properties of an
eye ;

Your ears, now worthless as wool, will become
gems ;

Yea, your whole body will become a mirror,
It will be as an eye of a bright gem in your
bosom.

First the hearing of the ear enables you to form
ideas,

Then these ideas guide you to the Beloved.

Strive, then, to increase the number of these
ideas,

That they may guide you, like Majnun, to the
Beloved.

“ THERE IS A PLACE OF REFUGE ”

Yea, O sleeping heart, know the kingdom that
endures not

For ever and ever is only a mere dream.

I marvel how long you will indulge in vain
illusion,

Which has seized you by the throat like a heads-
man.

Know that even in this world there is a place of
refuge ;

Hearken not to the unbeliever who denies it.

His argument is this : he says again and again,
“ If there were aught beyond this life we should
see it.”

But if the child see not the state of reason,
Does the man of reason therefore forsake
reason ?

And if the man of reason sees not the state of
Love,

Is the blessed moon of Love thereby eclipsed ?

THE LOVER'S CRY TO THE BELOVED

“ My back is broken by the conflict of my
thoughts ;

O Beloved One, come and stroke my head in
mercy !

The palm of Thy hand on my head gives me
rest,

Thy hand is a sign of Thy bounteous provi-
dence.

Remove not Thy shadow from my head,
I am afflicted, afflicted, afflicted !

Sleep has deserted my eyes
Through my longing for Thee, O Envy of cypresses !

O take my life, Thou art the Source of Life !
For apart from Thee I am wearied of my life.
I am a lover well versed in lovers' madness,
I am weary of learning and sense."

SORROW TURNED TO JOY

"He who extracts the rose from the thorn
Can also turn this winter into spring.
He who exalts the heads of the cypresses
Is able also out of sadness to bring joy."

THE GIFTS OF THE BELOVED

Where will you find one more liberal than God ?
He buys the worthless rubbish which is your
wealth,
He pays you the Light that illumines your heart.
He accepts these frozen and lifeless bodies of
yours,
And gives you a Kingdom beyond what you
dream of,
He takes a few drops of your tears,
And gives you the Divine Fount sweeter than
sugar.

He takes your sighs fraught with grief and
sadness,
And for each sigh gives rank in heaven as
interest.
In return for the sigh-wind that raised tear-
clouds,
God gave Abraham the title of "Father of the
Faithful."

"THOU ART HIDDEN FROM US"

Thou art hidden from us, though the heavens
are filled
With Thy Light, which is brighter than sun
and moon!
Thou art hidden, yet revealest our hidden
secrets!
Thou art the Source that causes our rivers to
flow.
Thou art hidden in Thy essence, but seen by Thy
bounties.
Thou art like the water, and we like the mill-
stone.
Thou art like the wind, and we like the dust;
The wind is unseen, but the dust is seen by all.
Thou art the Spring, and we the sweet green
garden;
Spring is not seen, though its gifts are seen.
Thou art as the Soul, we as hand and foot;
Soul instructs hand and foot to hold and take.

Thou art as Reason, we like the tongue ;
 'Tis reason that teaches the tongue to speak.
 Thou art as Joy, and we are laughing ;
 The laughter is the consequence of the joy.
 Our every motion every moment testifies,
 For it proves the presence of the Everlasting
 God.

“ EXERT YOURSELVES ”

“ ‘ Trust in God, yet tie the camel’s leg.’
 Hear the adage, ‘ The worker is the friend of
 God ; ’
 Through trust in Providence neglect not to use
 means.
 Go, O Fatalists, practise trust with self-exertion,
 Exert yourself to attain your objects, bit by bit.
 In order to succeed, strive and exert yourselves ;
 If you strive not for your objects, ye are fools.”

THE WISDOM OF THE WEAK

“ O friends, God has given me inspiration.
 Oftentimes strong counsel is suggested to the
 weak.
 The wit taught by God to the bee
 Is withheld from the lion and the wild ass.
 It fills its cells with liquid sweets,
 For God opens the door of this knowledge to it.

The skill taught by God to the silkworm
Is a learning beyond the reach of the elephant.
The earthly Adam was taught of God names,
So that his glory reached the seventh heaven.
He laid low the name and fame of the angels,
Yet blind indeed are they whom God dooms
to doubt ! ”

WHITE NIGHTS

Every night Thou freest our spirits from the body
And its snare, making them pure as rased tablets.
Every night spirits are released from this cage,
And set free, neither lording it nor lorded over.
At night prisoners are unaware of their prison,
At night kings are unaware of their majesty.

“ THE KINGLY SOUL ”

The kingly soul lays waste the body,
And after its destruction he builds it anew.
Happy the soul who for love of God
Has lavished family, wealth, and goods !—
Has destroyed its house to find the Hidden
Treasure,
And with that Treasure has rebuilt it in fairer
sort ;
Has dammed up the stream and cleansed the
channel,
And then turned a fresh stream into the channel

SAINT AND HYPOCRITE

Watch the face of each one, regard it well,
It may be by serving thou wilt recognise Truth's
face.

As there are many demons with men's faces,
It is wrong to join hand with every one.
When the fowler sounds his decoy whistle,
That the birds may be beguiled by that snare,
The birds hear that call simulating a bird's call,
And, descending from the air, find net and knife.
So vile hypocrites steal the language of Dervishes,
In order to beguile the simple with their trickery.
The works of the righteous are light and heat,
The works of the evil treachery and shamelessness.
They make stuffed lions to scare the simple,
They give the title of Muhammad to false Musai-
lima.

But Musailima retained the name of "Liar,"
And Muhammad that of "Sublimest of beings."
That wine of God (the righteous) yields a perfume
of musk ;
Other wine (the evil) is reserved for penalties
and pains.

HARSHNESS AND ADORATION

Let me then, I say, make complaint
Of the severity of that Fickle Fair One.

I cry, and my cries sound sweet in His ear ;
He requires from the two worlds cries and groans.
How shall I not wail under His chastening
hand ?

How shall I not be in the number of those bewitched by Him ?

How shall I be other than night without His day ?

Without the vision of His face that illumines the day ?

His bitters are very sweets to my soul,
I am enamoured of my own grief and pain,
For it makes me well-pleasing to my peerless
King.

I use the dust of my grief as salve for my eyes,
That my eyes, like seas, may team with pearls.

THE DIVINE ABSORPTION

Do me justice, O Thou who art the glory of the just,

Who art the throne, and I the lintel of Thy door !

But, in sober truth, where are throne and doorway ?

Where are " We " and " I " ? There where our Beloved is !

O Thou, who art exempt from " Us " and " Me,"
Who pervadest the spirits of all men and women ;

When man and woman become one, Thou art
that One !

When their union is dissolved, lo ! Thou abidest !
Thou hast made these " Us " and " Me " for this
purpose,

To wit, to play chess with them by Thyself.

When Thou shalt become one entity with " Us "
and " You,"

Then wilt Thou show true affection for these
lovers.

When these " We " and " Ye " shall all become
One Soul,

Then they will be lost and absorbed in the
" Beloved."

LOVE MORE THAN SORROW AND JOY

Come then, O Lord !

Who art exalted above description and explanation !

Is it possible for the bodily eye to behold Thee ?

Can mind of man conceive Thy frowns and Thy
smiles ?

Are hearts, when bewitched by Thy smiles and
frowns,

In a fit state to see the vision of Thyself ?

When our hearts are bewitched by Thy smiles
and frowns,

Can we gain Life from these two alternating
states ?

The fertile garden of Love, as it is boundless,
Contains other fruits besides joy and sorrow.
The true lover is exalted above these two states,
He is fresh and green independently of autumn
or spring !

Pay tithe on Thy beauty, O Beauteous One !
Tell forth the tale of the Beloved, every whit !

“ THE HEART OF THE HARPER ”

The heart of the harper was emancipated.
Like a soul he was freed from weeping and
rejoicing,
His old life died, and he was regenerated.
Amazement fell upon him at that moment,
For he was exalted above earth and heaven,
An uplifting of the heart surpassing all uplifting.
I cannot describe it ; if you can, say on !
Ecstasy and words beyond all ecstatic words ;—
Immersion in the glory of the Lord of glory !
Immersion wherefrom was no extrication,—
As it were identification with the Very Ocean !

“ WHEN NIGHT RETURNS ”

When night returns and 'tis the time of the sky's
levée,
The stars that were hidden come forth to their
work.

The people of the world lie unconscious,
With veils drawn over their faces, and asleep ;
But when the morn shall burst forth and the sun
 arise
Every creature will raise its head from its couch ;
To the unconscious God will restore consciousness ;
They will stand in rings as slaves with rings in
 ears ;
Dancing and clapping hands with songs of
 praise,
Singing with joy, " Our Lord hath restored us
 to life ! "

SEPARATION

Nothing is bitterer than severance from Thee,
Without Thy shelter there is naught but per-
 plexity.
Our worldly goods rob us of our heavenly goods,
Our body rends the garment of our soul.
Our hands, as it were, prey on our feet ;
Without reliance on Thee how can we live ?

" GOD'S LIGHT "

"Tis God's Light that illumines the senses' light,
That is the meaning of " Light upon light."
The senses' light draws us earthwards,
God's Light calls us heavenwards.

“ LOVE CASTS ITS OWN LIGHT ”

When love of God kindles a flame in the inward
man,
He burns, and is freed from effects.
He has no need of signs to assure him of Love,
For Love casts its own Light up to heaven.

“ THE BELIEVER'S HEART ”

The Prophet said that God has declared,
“ I am not contained in aught above or below,
I am not contained in earth or sky, or even
In highest heaven. . Know this for a surety, O
beloved !
Yet am I contained in the believer's heart !
If ye seek Me, search in such hearts ! ”

“ SELF-SATISFACTION ”

No sickness worse than fancying thyself perfect
Can infect thy soul, O arrogant misguided one !
Shed many tears of blood from eyes and heart,
That this self-satisfaction may be driven out.
The fate of Iblis lay in saying, “ I am better than
He,”
And this same weakness lurks in the souls of all
creatures.

“ TRUE KNOWLEDGE ”

The knowledge which is not of Him is a burden ;
Knowledge which comes not immediately from
Him

Endures no longer than the rouge of the tire-
woman.

Nevertheless, if you bear this burden in a right
spirit

’Twill be removed, and you will obtain joy.

See you bear not that burden out of vainglory,
Then you will behold a store of True Knowledge
within.

When you mount the steed of this True Know-
ledge,
Straightway the burden will fall from your
back.

“ THE FLAME OF LOVE ”

How long wilt thou dwell on words and super-
ficialities ?

A burning heart is what I want ; consort with
burning !

Kindle in thy heart the flame of Love,
And burn up utterly thoughts and fine ex-
pressions.

O Moses ! the lovers of fair rites are one class,
They whose hearts and souls burn with Love
another.

A MOTHER WHOSE CHILDREN WERE IN THE
BELOVED'S KEEPING

A woman bore many children in succession, but none of them lived beyond the age of three or four months. In great distress she cried to God, and then beheld in a vision the beautiful gardens of Paradise, and many fair mansions therein, and upon one of these mansions she read her own name inscribed. And a voice from heaven informed her that God would accept the sorrows she had endured in lieu of her blood shed in holy war, as, owing to her sex, she was unable to go out to battle like the men. On looking again, the woman beheld in Paradise all the children she had lost, and she cried, "O Lord ! they were lost to me, but safe with Thee ! "

THE OPTIMISTIC ROSE

In this tale there is a warning for thee, O Soul,
That thou mayest acquiesce in God's ordinances,
And be wary and not doubt God's benevolence,
When sudden misfortune befalls thee.
Let others grow pale from fear of ill fortune,
Do thou smile like the rose at loss and gain ;
For the rose, though its petals be torn asunder,
Still smiles on, and it is never cast down.

THE TRUE MOSQUE

Fools laud and magnify the mosque,
While they strive to oppress holy men of heart.
But the former is mere form, the latter spirit
and truth.
The only true mosque is that in the hearts of
saints.
The mosque that is built in the hearts of the
saints
Is the place of worship of all, for God dwells
there.
So long as the hearts of the saints are not afflicted,
God never destroys the nation.

“ IGNORANCE ”

Blood is impure, yet its stain is removed by
water ;
But that impurity of ignorance is more lasting,
Seeing that without the blessed water of God
It is not banished from the man who is subject
to it.
O that thou wouldst turn thy face to thy own
prayers,
And say, “ Ah ! my prayers are as defective
as my being ;
O requite me good for evil ! ”

A PRAYER

“ Pray in this wise and allay your difficulties :
‘ Give us good in the house of our present world,
And give us good in the house of our next world.
Make our path pleasant as a garden,
And be Thou, O Holy One, our goal ! ’ ”

ALL RELIGIONS ARE ONE

In the adorations and benedictions of righteous
men
The praises of all the prophets are kneaded to-
gether.
All their praises are mingled into one stream,
All the vessels are emptied into one ewer.
Because He that is praised is, in fact, only One.
In this respect all religions are only one religion.
Because all praises are directed towards God’s
Light,
These various forms and figures are borrowed
from it.

A NOTE ON PERSIAN POETRY

NĪZAMĪ'S DISCOURSE ON POETRY

IN NĪZAMĪ'S *The Chahār Magála* ("Four Discourses"), translated by Professor Edward G. Browne, we find the *Second Discourse* devoted to "The Nature of Poetry, and the Utility of the Skilful Poet." In this interesting Discourse NĪzamī very amiably discusses the training required to become a poet of enduring fame, and intersperses these remarks with a number of anecdotes, which in the main are examples of the advantages derived from poetic improvisations given at opportune moments before kings when wine has gone round two or three times. NĪzamī sums up the nature of poetry in the following words: "Poetry is that art whereby the poet arranges imaginary propositions and adapts the deductions, with the result that he can make a little thing appear great and a great thing small, or cause good to appear in the garb of evil and evil in the garb of good." NĪzamī denounces the habit of giving money to old poets. He remarks: "For one so ignoble as not to have

discovered in fifty years that what he writes is bad, when will he discover it ? ” On the other hand Nizami favours the young poet with hopeful talent, and generously remarks that “ it is proper to patronise him, a duty to take care of him, and an obligation to maintain him.” The minor poets of to-day have not these glowing advantages !

The most ingenious example of a poetic improvisation in this *Discourse* is, perhaps, one given by Rúdági in connection with the protracted stay of Amír Nasr b. Ahmad in Herát. Four years the Amír camped with his army in this town, with its twenty different varieties of grape and beautiful narcissus. “ He preferred Herát to the Garden of Eden.” But at length the Amír’s captains and courtiers grew weary of being absent so long from Bukhárá, where they longed to see their wives and children again. They offered Rúdági, the poet, five thousand dinars if he could persuade the Amír to quit Herát and return to Bukhárá. Rúdági, at an opportune moment, took up his harp and sang the following song to the Amír :

The sands of Oxus, toilsome though they be,
Beneath my feet were soft as silk to me.
Glad at the friend’s return, the Oxus deep
Up to our girths in laughing waves shall leap.
Long live Bukhárá ! Be thou of good cheer !
Joyous towards thee hasteth our Amír !

The Moon's the Prince, Bukhárá is the sky ;
O sky, the Moon shall light thee by and bye !
Bukhará is the mead, the Cypress he ;
Receive at last, O Mead, thy Cypress-tree !

This particular Amír seems to have been fond of flattery, and he found the daintily turned song of Rúdági more acceptable to his vanity than even the beauty of Herát. He accordingly took his departure immediately the song had concluded, and, in his absent-mindedness, forgot to put on his boots, which were carried by an attendant who rode in hot pursuit.

Poetry in those days was evidently a remunerative pursuit. Nízamí tells us that Khidr Khán always had in readiness four trays of gold. "These he used to dispense by the handful" to the successful poets. Though the royal favour towards the poets was extremely bountiful, Persian poets were not always particularly courteous the one to the other. Nízamí tells an amusing story of a minor poet named Rashídí. At the king's command the Poet-Laureate was asked to express his opinion of Rashídí's poetry. The Poet-Laureate accordingly remarked : "His verse is extremely good and chaste and correct, but it wants spice." The king afterwards repeated these words to Rashídí and bade him compose a fitting rejoinder. Rashídí composed the following verse :

You stigmatise my verse as "wanting spice,"
And possibly, my friend, you may be right.
My verse is honey-flavoured, sugar-sweet,
And spice with such could scarcely cause delight.
Spice is for you, you blackguard, not for me,
For beans and turnips is the stuff you write !

This was not kind ; but Rashídí received all four baskets of gold that day !

The technical study of prosody was instituted by Khalil ibn i Ahmad i Bicrí. He is said to have discovered this science by listening to the rythmic beats of the fuller's mallets upon his clothes. This story is mentioned in Saifi's *Treatise on Prosody*.¹

Much of Persian poetry is conventional, and the demarcation in style, due to the various phases of Persian history, is not as pronounced as might be expected. The Persian poets not only conservatively followed old metres, but old similes, old subjects as well. It was with words they were most concerned, and not with ideas. The *Lover's Companion* of Sharafu'd-Dín Rámí is sufficient to prove this. The book contains a very large number of similes on the various parts of the body. This was intended to be a *vade mecum* to the writer of erotic poetry. Professor Brown defends this conservatism and

language from the vulgarisation which the triumph of an untrained, untrammelled, and unconventional genius of the barbaric-degenerate type tends to produce in our own and other European tongues."

THE WISDOM OF THE EAST SERIES

Edited by L. CRANMER-BYNG and Dr. S. A. KAPADIA



THE SERIES AND ITS PURPOSE

THE object of the Editors of this Series is a very definite one. They desire above all things that, in their humble way, these books shall be the ambassadors of good-will and understanding between East and West—the old world of Thought and the new of Action. In this endeavour, and in their own sphere, they are but followers of the highest example in the land. They are confident that a deeper knowledge of the great ideals and lofty philosophy of Oriental thought may help to a revival of that true spirit of Charity which neither despises nor fears the nations of another creed and colour.

NEW VOLUMES

In the Press

TAOIST TEACHINGS. From the Mystical Philosophy of Leih Tzū. Translated by LIONEL GILES, M.A. 2/- net.

INDIAN

THE HEART OF INDIA. Sketches in the History of Hindu Religion and Morals. By L. D. BARNETT, M.A., LITT.D., Professor of Sanskrit at University College, London. 2/- net.

BRAHMA-KNOWLEDGE: An Outline of the Philosophy of the Vedānta. As set forth by the Upanishads and by Sankara. By L. D. BARNETT, M.A., LITT.D., Professor of Sanskrit at University College, London. 2/- net.

[Continued over]

THE PATH OF LIGHT. Rendered for the first time into English from the Bodhi-charyāvatāra of Śānti-Deva. A Manual of Mahā-Yāna Buddhism. By L. D. Barnett, M.A., Litt.D. 2/- net.

LEGENDS OF INDIAN BUDDHISM. Translated from "L'Introduction à l'Histoire du Bouddhisme Indien" of Eugène Burnouf, with an Introduction by WINIFRED STEPHENS. 2/- net.

THE WAY OF THE BUDDHA. Selections from the Buddhist texts, together with the original Pāli, with Introduction by HERBERT BAYNES, M.R.A.S. 2/- net.

IRANIAN (Persian, Pelevi, Zend, etc.)

THE RUBÁ'YÁT OF HÁFIZ. Translated with Introduction by SYED ABDUL MAJID, LL.D. Rendered into English Verse by L. CRANMER-BYNG. 1/- net.

THE SPLENDOUR OF GOD. Being Extracts from the Sacred Writings of the Bahais. With Introduction by ERIC HAMMOND. 2/- net.

THE TEACHINGS OF ZOROASTER, and the Philosophy of the Parsi Religion. Translated with Introduction by Dr. S. A. KAPADIA, Lecturer, University College, London. 2/- net.

THE PERSIAN MYSTICS.

I. Jalálu'd-dín Rúmí. By F. HADLAND DAVIS. 2/- net.

II. Jámí. By F. HADLAND DAVIS. 2/- net.

THE BUSTĀN OF SA'DI. From the Persian. Translated with Introduction by A. HART EDWARDS. 2/- net.

SA'DI'S SCROLL OF WISDOM. By SHAIKH SA'DI. With Introduction by Sir ARTHUR N. WOLLASTON, K.C.I.E. 1/- net.
With Persian Script added. 2/- net.

THE ROSE GARDEN OF SA'DI. Selected and Rendered from the Persian with Introduction by L. CRANMER-BYNG. 1/- net.

ARABIC

THE ALCHEMY OF HAPPINESS. By AL GHAZZALI. Rendered into English by CLAUD FIELD. 2/- net.

THE CONFESSIONS OF AL GHAZZALI. Translated for the first time into English by CLAUD FIELD, M.A. 1/- net.

THE AWAKENING OF THE SOUL. From the Arabic of IBN TUFAIL. Translated with Introduction by PAUL BRÖNNLE, Ph.D. 1/6 net.

THE RELIGION OF THE KORAN. With Introduction by Sir ARTHUR N. WOLLASTON, K.C.I.E. 1/- net.

ARABIAN WISDOM. Selections and Translations from the Arabic by JOHN WORTABET, M.D. 1/- net.

THE SINGING CARAVAN. Some Echoes of Arabian Poetry. By HENRY BAERLEIN. 2/- net.

THE DIWAN OF ABU'L-ALA. By HENRY BAERLEIN. 1/- net.

HEBREW

ANCIENT JEWISH PROVERBS. Compiled and Classified by A. COHEN, late Scholar of Emanuel College, Cambridge. 2/- net.

THE WISDOM OF THE APOCRYPHA. With an Introduction by C. E. LAWRENCE, Author of "Pilgrimage," etc. 2/- net.

THE WISDOM OF ISRAEL: Being Extracts from the Babylonian Talmud and Midrash Rabboth. Translated from the Aramaic with an Introduction by EDWIN COLLINS. 1/- net.

THE DUTIES OF THE HEART. By RABBI BACHYE. Translated from the Hebrew with Introduction by EDWIN COLLINS. Hollier Hebrew Scholar, U.C.L. 1/- net.

CHINESE

A LUTE OF JADE. Being Selections from the Classical Poets of China. Rendered with an Introduction by L. CRANMER-BYNG. 2/- net.

THE CLASSICS OF CONFUCIUS.

I. **The Book of Odes (Shi-King).**
By L. CRANMER-BYNG. 1/- net.

II. **The Book of History (Shu-King).**
By W. GORN OLD. 1/- net.

CAMBRIDGE UNIVERSITY PRESS

London: FETTER LANE, E.C.

C. F. CLAY, MANAGER



Edinburgh: 100, PRINCES STREET

Berlin: A. ASHER AND CO.

Leipzig: F. A. BROCKHAUS

New York: G. P. PUTNAM'S SONS

Bombay and Calcutta: MACMILLAN AND CO., LTD.